

Now, using your camera flash often can drain your battery much too quickly. For this reason, and to achieve more powerful illumination, external flash units are used. The flash within your camera can sometime be harsh on nearby people, but may not be useful for subjects slightly farther away. Often external units are bounced off a distant wall or ceiling to adequately illuminate such subjects while giving additional ease with modification of brackets, diffusers, filters and so on. External flashes also lie a little further from the camera's line of sight thus reducing red-eye and slightly improve light quality. In general too, red eye can be a big problem faced, caused by a flash which glares back from the subject's pupil, shining as a red due to high intensity of blood vessels present in that part of the pupil. When your flash is too focused and directional or your subject is looking directly at the camera with dilated pupils from the dim ambient light, unnatural red eyes are difficult to escape. Some cameras have a red eye reduction mode which starts with sending a series of smaller flashes so that person's pupils are contracted during the actual flash. If your camera does not have this mode, try taking pictures as far as possible in increased amounts of ambient light. Either way, it is difficult to eliminate the effect all together but it makes it much less prominent.

The best examples of flash photography are those when you do not even recognize that a flash has been used. Apart from the technique, lots of experimentation and practice can actually make you do wonders with this most essential of photography tools. 